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Siem Reap

The town of **Siem Reap** (សៀមរាប), in northern Cambodia, is the primary access point for the Angkor Archaeological Park, just north of the city. It is quite laid-back and a pleasant place to stay while touring the temples. It is a nice compromise between observing Cambodian life and enjoying the amenities of modern services and entertainment, thanks to a large foreign community.

Understand

The name "Siem Reap" literally means "Siam Defeated", commemorating a (possibly apocryphal) victory over invading Thais in 1549. These days, however, the only rampaging hordes are the tourists heading to the Angkor Archaeological Park. This once quaint village has become a major tourist town, full of things to do, places to eat and drink. New high quality tarmac roads and beautiful wide paved sidewalks have replaced the red dirt pot holed roads that were muddy in wet season, and dusty in dry season. The building boom is mostly over, and it's now a very pleasant town with lots of beautiful shady trees, especially along the riverbanks and roads around Angkor Wat.



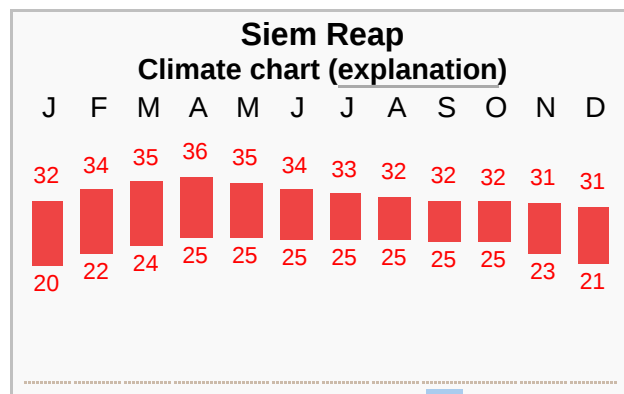
French colonial architecture still dominates the streetscape.

Check out the ConCERT tourist office, a local NGO committed to raising the standards of responsible tourism and eco-tourism activities and providing information on the causes and effects of poverty in Cambodia, volunteering opportunities and eco-tours.

Get in

By plane

1 Siem Reap-Angkor International Airport (SAI IATA). Opened in October 2023, this clean and cool space is the country's largest airport. Being 50 km out



of town, travel to and from this new airport costs more (except for seats on the minibus) and takes much longer than to the old airport, which has closed. It has one terminal and is served by international direct flights from Bangkok (both airports), Kuala Lumpur, Singapore, and various airports in Laos (Luang Prabang) and Vietnam (Hanoi, Ho Chi Minh, Da Nang, Phu Quoc). Flights from Seoul, Kunming, and Shanghai were scheduled to begin by early 2024. Cambodia Angkor Air flies domestic from Phnom Penh and Sihanoukville as well. US\$8 per minibus seat, US\$40 for private minivan transfer. (updated Oct 2025)

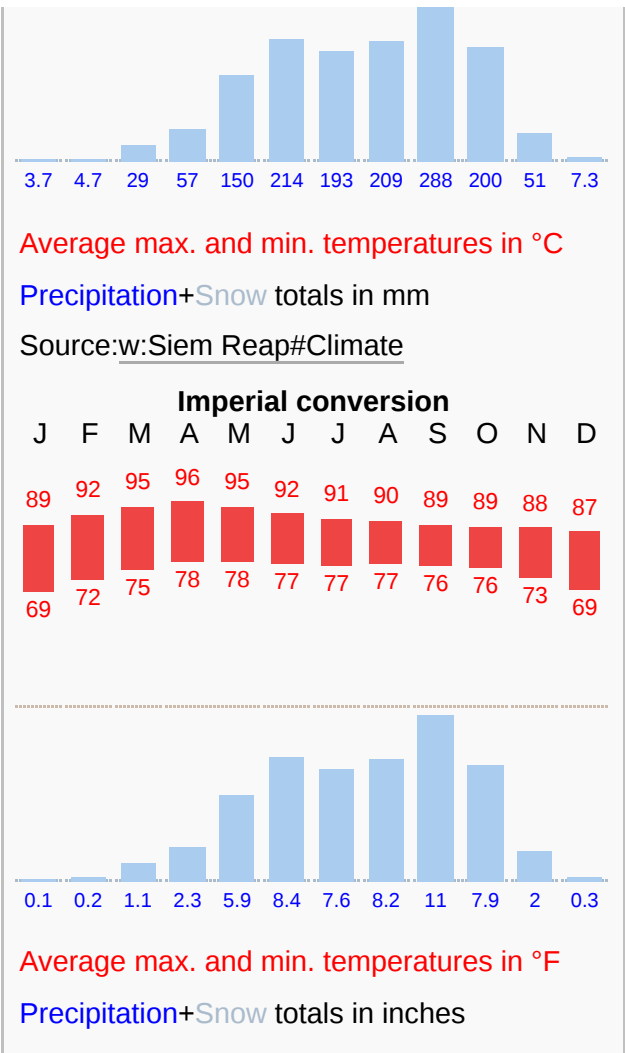
By bus

Bus is a common way for getting around Cambodia with a range of bus companies serving Siem Reap, with several daily departures and arrivals (especially from Phnom Penh). Premium operators includes Giant Ibis (<https://www.giantibis.com/>) and VET Air Bus Express (<https://www.vetairbus.com/>), while companies such as Larryta, Seila Angkor Express (<https://www.seilaangkorexpress.com/>), E-Booking, Mey Hong (<https://www.meyhongbus.com/>) and others offer economy options with Air Conditioning. Try to book at least the day before travel. Booking online is easier with BookMeBus (<https://bookmebus.com/en/search/bus/phnom-penh/siem-reap>) and Camboticket (<https://www.camboticket.com>), as you can board with e-ticket with either of their services. Travel agents and guesthouses will do this for a US\$1-2 fee per ticket. Buses tend to leave in the morning or early afternoon. There are also night buses on some routes.

Many buses terminate at an out-of-town bus station to the east of Siem Reap, from where travellers will need to take a tuk-tuk into town. This should cost no more than US\$2, or maybe US\$3 if you're not keen to drive a hard bargain. If arriving **from the west**, consider getting off the bus as it passes through town on National Road 6, say as it crosses the bridge over the river, before it reaches the bus station. If arriving **from the east** you have little choice but to face the touts.

Domestic services

Domestic services are frequent — for instance Phnom Penh is served by a dozen companies some of which have a departure every half hour during the day. The bus trip from the capital is 6-8 hours and tickets are around US\$10 depending on the company. This is a well traveled route by both locals and tourists, but often an uncomfortable trip, as buses make many stops and go slow. A more expensive, but far more comfortable option is by Wi-Fi-equipped minibus (US\$15 from Giant Ibis or US\$12 from Mekong Express, 2020). The trip by minibus takes only 4-5 hours.



From	Company (comments)	Departs	Hours	US\$
<u>Phnom Penh</u>	Mekong Express (air-con, snack, water, guide)	07:00 08:30 12:30 14:25	6	12
	Apsara Khmer Travel (air-con, water)	07:00 09:00 13:30 15:30	5	9
	Gold VIP (air-con, snack, water)	07:00 08:30 13:30 14:30 20:00 24:00	5-6	9
	Selia Angkor (air-con, snack, water)	07:00 09:00 14:00 15:00	5	9
	Virak Buntham	11:30 (5 hr) 18:00 20:00 24:00 (6 hr)		9
	Sok Sokha (cold towel, air-con, snack, water)	07:30 08:30 12:30 13:30	6	8
	Capitol (air-con)	06:15 07:30 08:30 10:15 12:00 13:30 14:30	6.5	7
	Phnom Penh Sorya (air-con)	07:00 07:45 08:45 11:30 12:45 15:15	7	7



At a bus terminal



Other places with services include Kampong Cham, Soung, Battambang (US\$6-8), Sisophon, Poipet, Preah Vihear (US\$12) and Anlong Veng. Destinations further away include Koh Kong (via Phnom Penh, a long journey), Sihanoukville (US\$15-25) by a 10-12 hour overnight sleeping bus or daytime sitting bus that should be booked at least 1 day in advance, Banlung (US\$24), Mondulkiri (US\$18-24.50), Stung Treng (US\$20) and Kratie (US\$24).

International services

Laos

There are buses from Don Det in the 4,000 Islands region (US\$25-29), the Lao border (US\$25) nearby and Pakse (US\$30). Direct buses from Vientiane don't seem to be available as of February 2019.

Thailand



WARNING: Avoid travelling within 50 km of the Thai border due to border skirmishes. Many overland travel options from Thailand will remain closed; check official sources for up-to-date information on this conflict.

Government travel advisories

Australia (<https://www.smartraveller.gov.au/destinations/asia/cambodia>) • Canada (<https://travel.gc.ca/destinations/cambodia>) • United Kingdom (<https://www.gov.uk/foreign-travel-advice/cambodia>) • United States (<https://th.usembassy.gov/fighting-on-the-thailand-cambodia-border/>) • Hong Kong (<https://www.sb.gov.hk/eng/ota/note-Thailand.html>)

(Information last updated 01 Feb 2026)

Since June 2025, all buses from Thailand into Cambodia have been suspended due to border skirmishes.

Vietnam

Ho Chi Minh City (US\$18-27) 12 hr on a sleeping bus. If you use this in the other direction, have your Vietnam visa ready (if your nationality needs one) and valid before taking this trip. Visas for Vietnam are not available at a land border even if you have visa on arrival.

By boat

- **2 Phnom Krom Port.** The port you arrive at is about 20 minutes south of Siem Reap by tuk-tuk. The drivers will try to charge you US\$5 per person but the trip should not cost more than US\$5 in total. (updated Jan 2017)

A more expensive and more time consuming option from Battambang (US\$20-25, 5 hr) is to take a Soviet-style hydrofoil across Tonle Sap Lake. These can be fantastic trips giving you the opportunity to view life on the lake, floating houses, working fishermen, and to get a suntan if you choose to sit on the roof of the boat. However, the trip can be ruined due to bad weather. Remember to use sunscreen and take a waterproof jacket. You may not be able to access your luggage during the journey (sometimes the baggage is available, sometimes it is not). If you have the time, it is better to visit the floating villages as day trips from Siem Reap rather than see them from the boat.

Ferries from Phnom Penh are suspended since COVID.

By shared taxi

The quickest method of getting from the Poipet border to Siem Reap is a **shared car**. A four-seater car costs US\$25-45, depending on your bargaining prowess, and takes 2-3 hr. Even if you're travelling solo, it shouldn't be too hard to find others to share the expense. Walk past the roundabout to negotiate a cheaper taxi fare, otherwise you will pay more by being in the police controlled pricing cartel area. Do not get on the "government approved" tourist bus unless you want to pay more for taxis minibus, etc.

By private transfer

Group of tourists or families can book a private transfer to Siem Reap. It is comfortable, but expensive way. Comfort-class transfer from the Poipet costs US\$65-75.

By helicopter

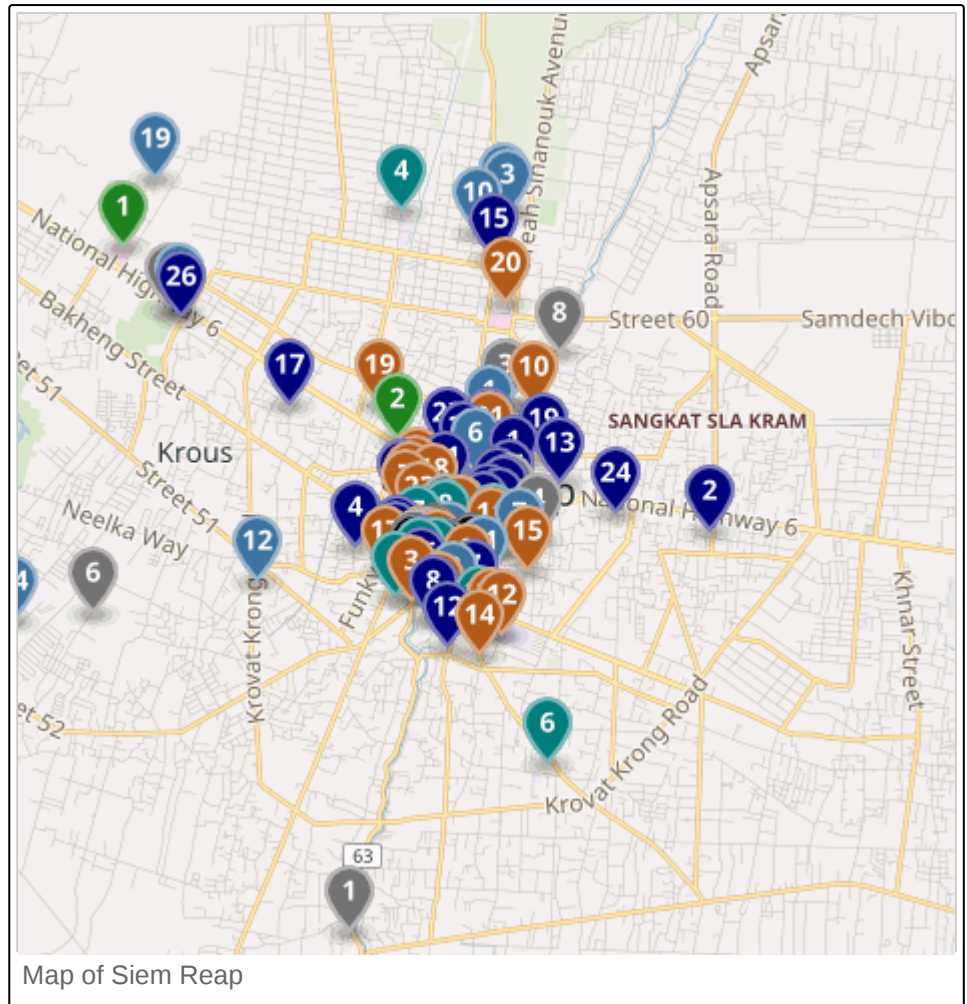
Helicopters can be chartered to go nearly anywhere in the country. They seat 5-6 people. Prices start at US\$1,000 for trips to some of the temples north of Angkor Wat. Companies include Helicopters Cambodia (<http://www.helicopterscambodia.com/>) and Helistar Cambodia (<http://www.helistarcambodia.com/>). Helicopter transport is also available from other cities, e.g. from Battambang (US\$1,600/helicopter) or Phnom Penh (US\$4,700/helicopter).

Get around

Travel to and around the Angkor Archaeological Park is extensively covered in its own article. The following is a discussion of travel inside Siem Reap.

On foot

The city centre is fairly compact and flat, now with good quality and often wide, paved sidewalks. Though in places you can find them doubling up as motorbike and car parking lots. However, as Siem Reap has grown, many interesting neighborhoods have popped up that are further outside of the main downtown business district, and are a bit out of the way for pedestrians.



By bicycle

Siem Reap is a popular place to cycle, with some scenic cycle paths painted green, or trails in forests near roads leading to and around Angkor Wat. There is also a green cycle path running along side the river, often in the shade of large trees, starting at the Hard Rock Cafe, then heading north. Bicycle rental shops around town mostly don't open earlier than 07:00, so if you want to ride to Angkor Wat early in the morning, rent one the day before. Some guesthouses also rent bicycles. One day rental varies between US\$1 to US\$8, depending on the quality of the bike. Discounts available for longer rentals. Guided electric mountain bike tours are also available in Siem Reap, offering pedal-assist bikes that make the Angkor circuit more manageable in the heat, with access to jungle trails not accessible by tuk-tuk or bus.

By motorbike

Motodops (motorbike taxi) abound and will make sure you know where they are. Rides within town should only cost US\$0.50 or 2,000 riel, although prices can double at night or during bad weather. Agree a price first. Full day can be arranged for ~US\$10. Helmets for passengers are rare though may materialize if requested in advance.

Renting motorbikes is no longer prohibited. There are plenty of options available from the ubiquitous gasoline-driven scooters (starting at ~US\$8 per day), small electric scooters for one with a top speed of 25 km/h (~US\$10) to larger ones for two people going up to 60 km/h (~US\$15). It can also be possible to rent a motorbike only for half a day, so you will pay only half the daily rate. You may need to leave either your passport or US\$100-300 as a collateral, while some places only take a photo of your passport and don't take any deposits. Driving inside the city isn't very stressful (as well as going to [Angkor](#)), especially in comparison with huge Asian cities (for example [Bangkok](#)) or countries with more chaotic driving approach like Vietnam.

Wear a helmet, both for your safety and because the police will stop you at checkpoints and fine you US\$15 if you don't. Some restaurants will let you charge the battery.

By tuk-tuk

Tuk-tuks or Cambodian-style remorques (two-wheeled carriages pulled behind a motorbike), hang out on street corners, or you can summon one on your phone with Grab or PassApp.

A typical short trip within Siem Reap should cost about US\$1.25 (5000 riel) regardless of how many people pile on. Most 3-wheeled tuk-tuks can carry two or three people, or a Remorque can carry four people comfortably, though the extra weight can make the low-powered bikes go slower. Some modern Remorques are being made even bigger and more luxurious, for extra comfort or to carry 6 people pulled by a more powerful motorbike and wider sporty car style chariot wheels. The iconic-looking Remorques are slowly disappearing in many parts of Cambodia, such as Phnom Penh, as the cheaper to buy bog-standard tuk-tuks replace them, but in Siem Reap, Remorques are still very popular with tourists, as they are more comfortable, fun, and give a better view, especially for larger-sized people, than the smaller, cramped 3-wheeled tuk-tuks. Their drivers tend to speak a higher level of English, as they transport mostly tourists.

There are also electric tuk-tuks, by a company called TADA, and they use their own booking app of the same name.

Prices can go up at night or during bad weather. It's also possible to hire a tuk tuk driver for a full day to explore Angkor, it can cost ~US\$20, a bit more if you go early for sunrise or stay late for sunset.

Ensure you and the driver are in crystal clear agreement on the destination and total fare before departure. Payment is made on arrival and doesn't increase if the driver gets lost or has to take a circuitous route.



Tuk tuks wait for customers at Pub Street

By car

Cars with drivers can be hired for single or multiple days. While all drivers are familiar with the area and happy to suggest good routes, most speak little English and are not actual tour guides. Licensed tour guides charge US\$45-50 per day for a driver and English speaking guide. Drivers will likely ask for US\$5-10 extra for trips to further temples such as those of the Big Circuit, Banteay Srey and more for remote sites like Beng Mealea.

- **Siem Reap Transport Service (<http://siemreaptransportservice.com>)**. A private tuk-tuk and car service providing transportation within Siem Reap and around the Angkor Wat temples. Private cars also available to and from Phnom Penh.
- **Siem Reap Private Driver (<https://siemreapprivatedriver.com/>)**. This service run by two brothers Sa and Sout who offer transportation in luxury cars. They can also arrange for guides with drivers.

See

Most people come to visit **Angkor Archaeological Park**, which is thoroughly covered in its own article. The town has some worthwhile attractions and a number of beautiful modern Buddhist temples.

- **1 Angkor National Museum (<http://www.angkor-national-museum.com/index>)**, 968 Charles de Gaulle Blvd (*T Galleria department store, beside the museum, runs a free shuttle (a little train) from the Old Market, every 30 min from 10:30 except on W*), ☎ +855 63 966 601, info@the-anm.com (mailto: info@the-anm.com). Daily 08:30-18:00. A modern museum with exhibits covering the history of the Khmer Empire, and the art, architecture, clothing, and culture of Khmer civilization, with a special focus on the Angkor complex. It is worth spending a couple of hours in the air-conditioned galleries as a break from visiting temples. Lots of pre-Angkorian and Angkorian statues, plus informative videos. Some say the 1,000 Buddhas room is as impressive as it sounds. The gift shop has some lovely souvenirs and fascinating books, but they're very overpriced. Visitors are required to check bags, water, and hats at the entrance (for free). Photography prohibited. US\$12; audio guide in many languages US\$5 (credit card accepted). (updated Feb 2020)
- **2 APOPO (<https://apopo.org/support-us/apopo-visitor-center/>)**, Trapeang Ses Village, Kouk Chauk Commune, Siem Reap Koumai Road, ☎ +855 81599237, visitor.center@apopo.org (mailto: visitor.center@apopo.org). Daily tours every half hour 08:30–11:30 and 13:00–16:30. A demining organization that uses trained rats to sniff out land mines, a strategy which is much faster and safer than using metal detectors (if the rats step on a mine, they are too light to set it off). The visitor's center has guided tours including examples of land mines and UXO (unexploded ordnance) and a demonstration of how the rats find mines. The tour takes about 45 minutes and is a fascinating way to learn about the problem of land mines in Cambodia and support demining work. The guide's English may be hard to understand, but the demonstrations are so interesting, the tour is well worth doing anyway. US\$10. (updated Mar 2024)
- **3 Angkor Botanical Garden (<https://web.facebook.com/angkorbotanicalgardenABG>)** (rear entrance opposite Apopo). Beautifully kept gardens and mini zoo and playground with



The reclining Buddha at Wat Preah Prom Rath ↗

Rukha Cafe & Restaurant. A great place to visit just after visiting Apopo. free entry.

- **4 Lotus Silk Farm (<https://lotussilkfarm.com/>)**, 9, Road 63, Phnom Krom, ☎ +855 9252 9001, contact@lotussilkfarm.com (<mailto:contact@lotussilkfarm.com>). Daily 08:00-18:00. The lotus silk farm offers guided tours every hour, providing visitors with a comprehensive understanding of the lotus silk production process. For those seeking a more hands-on experience, the farm also offers handicraft workshops where participants can learn Cambodian traditional handicraft techniques. The farm features a shop with variety of lotus silk products, cosmetics and jewels, and a tea lounge where guests can savor traditional lotus tea. Adult US\$5, free for kids less than 12. (updated Sep 2024)
- **5 Angkor Eye (<https://angkoreye.com/>)**, Phum Krous (a 15-min drive NW of town on Route 6), ☎ +855 63 210 770. Daily 14:00–18:00. An 85-m-high Ferris wheel with 48 four-person baskets able to accommodate up to 192 people. The trip takes 18 minutes. It is the third highest Ferris wheel in Asia. Adult US\$12, child US\$6. (updated Feb 2020)
- **6 Flying Foxes**. A large colony of day time flying fruit bats (they can see unlike most smaller species of bat), can be found hanging around in some of the tall trees in the parkland adjacent to the Royal Residence, an amazing sight you don't expect to see in the center of town.

Temples

- **7 Wat Bo**, Samdech Tep Vong St and St 22 (*east side of the river; follow the road that continues from over Wat Bo Bridge*). As one of the oldest temples it makes a nice contrast between the oldest and the glittering new ones, though the rough artwork wouldn't match the craftsmen of Angkor. The architecture of the ramshackle open air hall next to the main building blends French-style arches and balustrades with Thai-influenced Buddhist details. A forest of chedi surround the main hall, in between frangipani trees and some fine topiary.
- **8 Wat Damnak (<https://khmerstudies.org/>)** (*east side of Siem Reap River, just east of Art Night Market, on Wat Damnak Road*). A landscaped temple with many stupas, a small decorative pool, and a school on the premises. Within the site of the temple is the Center for Khmer Studies, an open reading library with materials about the art, culture and history of Southeast Asia with specific interests in Cambodia. (updated Feb 2019)
- **9 Wat Preah Prom Rath**, Pokambor Ave. The glittering modern temple grounds give few hints as to its 500-year history. Though the lotus-themed architecture seems to emulate temples from over the border, the front gate integrates Bayon-style heads and a scene in relief of the Buddha seated under a tree, while armies fire arrows on one side and others are eaten by crocodiles on the other side, that looks like it could have been taken directly from Angkorian mural. Legend is that the site was established around 1500 when a famous monk landed ashore on a piece of his sinking boat. The boat wood was carved into the oddly foreshortened reclining Buddha installed in a swimming pool-like pit behind the imposing, yet despondent looking, seated Buddha in the main hall. Perhaps mimicking the construction materials origins, the reclining Buddha has taken on a sunken slant at the feet end. A pair of small weather worn cannons on either side of the hall are of unknown origin but their style, an embossed crown-like seal and mysterious numbers suggest a European origin.
- **10 Wat Thmei Temple & Stupa Memorial to the Killing Fields**. A large Buddhist temple. In the grounds is a stupa with glass sides contains bones and skulls of victims of Pol Pot's army. Be wary of people purporting to be guides or asking for donations. Also, several of the photographs on the display boards are actually of the Holocaust in Nazi Germany. Take this attraction with a pinch of salt. Free, donations welcome.

Cultural performances

- **11 Apsara Theatre (<https://apsaratheatre.asia/>)**, Wat Bo Rd. Daily performance 20:30-21:30. Showcases Cambodia's rich cultural heritage, traditional performing arts. Dancers, singers and musicians. US\$33.
- **12 Phare The Cambodian Circus (<https://pharecircus.org>)** (Phare Circus Ring Road, just south of the intersection with Sok San Road). Nightly 1-hr performances at 20:00. Phare performers use theater, music, dance, comedy and modern circus arts, to tell uniquely Cambodian stories; historical, folk and modern. It's typically a 15-minute tuk tuk ride from Siem Reap town centre (\$3). Adult US\$18-38, child (5-11) US\$10-18. (updated Feb 2026)



Traditional musicians at a temple

Nearby

- **13 Banteay Srey Butterfly Centre (<http://www.angkorbutterfly.com/>)**, Sanday Village (3 km before the Landmine Museum on the road to Banteay Srey temple), ☎ +855 97 852 7852. 09:00-1700. Banteay Srey Butterfly Centre is a community development project and tourist destination just down the road from the Landmine Museum and Banteay Srey temple. Revenue from admissions is used to pay families in remote villages who are farming butterflies for the exhibit. The project makes a real difference to the farmers' livelihoods and provides a wonderful experience for visitors as they can see spectacular local butterfly species flying close at hand in a beautiful tropical garden. US\$4 adults, US\$2 children under 12.
- **14 Butterfly Paradise (<http://www.butterflyparadisene.net>)**, Kantrak Village (5 km from Psar Chas Market on Butterfly Paradise Road), ☎ +855 12558768, butterflyparadisene@gmail.com (mailto:butterflyparadisene@gmail.com). Su-F 09:00-16:30. A park with butterflies amongst many species of plants and flowers, with waterfalls and ponds. US\$10 adult, US\$7 child, US\$4 Khmer adult, US\$2 Khmer child.
- **15 Kampong Phluk Floating Village (off the Highway to Phnom Penh)**. This mangrove forest offers a much more authentic floating village experience than the one close to the Tonlé Sap ferry harbour. This fascinating fishing village on stilts can be reached by tuk-tuk, motorcycle, or taxi from Siem Reap. It takes about 1 hour to reach the village, depending weather conditions. Beware of scams. In addition to the tuk-tuk or taxi fare, the boat to take you around the village costs US\$25 per person (which drivers will often conveniently forget to mention until you're almost there). In the dry season the village just has the appearance of a bunch of houses on stilts over the mud, but is still somewhat interesting as you can see the houses' structure. After touring the village you can eat in a floating restaurant with views of the lake. US\$25. (updated Feb 2020)
- **16 Landmine Museum (<http://www.cambodialandminemuseum.org>)** (6 km south of Banteay Srey Temple, 31 km from Siem Reap), ☎ +855 15 674 163. Daily 08:00–17:00. This tiny museum was set up by local deminer Aki Ra to educate locals and tourists about the dangers of land mines. Piles of defused mines and unexploded ordnance (UXO) lie around the site and the guides are mostly teenagers who were orphaned or injured by



Butterfly Paradise's giant caterpillar

mines, many of whom live on-site. This is a very worthwhile attraction that brings home the scale of the problem and shows you a slice of real Cambodia. Used clearance charts from their demining operations are available for purchase at the gift shop, letting you buy the organization's waste to support their operations. US\$5. (updated Mar 2024)



Piles of mines, Landmine Museum

- **17 Phnom Bok.** The highest hill in the area. Temple ruins similar to those found atop of Phnom Krom and Phnom Bakong can also be found on top of Phnom Bok. It lies 20 km to the north east of Siem Reap. Expect a tiring hike up the stairs. A guard may be able to show you around. Don't forget to check out the old howitzers from the civil war. Admission is free, no pass is needed for the Angkorian ruins.
- **18 Phnom Krom.** The hill which dominates the view, as you approach the floating village of Chong Kneas from Siem Reap. At the top, temple ruins similar to the other two hills can be found. This particular hill is popular for sunsets, as it can be viewed over the flooded plains during the wet season, and over incredibly vibrant rice fields in the dry season.
- **19 War museum (<https://www.facebook.com/warmuseumcambodia/>)** (*National Hwy 6 heading west, turn right after Cultural village*), ☎ +855 97 4578 666. Daily 08:00–17:30. Collection of old (mainly Russian) tanks, artillery, landmines, handguns etc. Also some history background about the Cambodian civil war is displayed. Worthwhile for a 1-2 hour visit if interested in military. US\$5. (updated Aug 2017)

Do

Activities

- **1 Angkor Pottery Center (<http://www.angkorpotterycenter.com>)** (*3 km South of Old Market on Road 63*), ☎ +855 12 755 286. Daily 08:00-17:00. Daily pottery classes for beginners as well as professionals in pottery making, carving and glazing by local potter, Mrs Paruth Hann. Make your own design and take your glazed pot home as a souvenir. An enjoyable experience whilst supporting an enterprise creating fair wage jobs for the poor village women in Siem Reap. US\$7-20.
- **2 Samatoa Experience (<http://www.lotussilkfarm.com>)**, 11, road 63, Phnom Krom, Siem Reap (*8 km South of Old Market on Road 63*), ☎ +855 92 51 9001. Daily 08:00-18:00. Daily handicraft classes for kids and adults in yarn spinning, paper, incense stick-making and bracelet-making taught by local experts. US\$25-45.
- **3 Pottery Classes & Painting classes (<http://www.khmercerceramics.com/classes-and-activities/>)**, 130, vithey Charles de Gaulle (*On the main Temple road very near the Angkor national museum, 30m after the traffics light on the right hand side*), ☎ +855 17 843 014, info@khmercerceramics.com (<mailto:info@khmercerceramics.com>). Daily 08:00 to 20:00. With the pottery class and clay class course, you can make your own ceramic artifact on the potter wheel. After you finish your piece, you can add different designs on it with potter's tools. With the painting activities, you can draw and / or paint your own design on a pot, cup, plate or other kinds of ceramics products. All activities from US\$15.

Activities for children

- **4 Kameng Leng ~ Daycare, Playground & Restaurant (<https://www.kamengleng.com/>)**, ☎ +855 96 988 0184. This is a fun, safe, creative, indoor-outdoor play and activity and education center with day care service and restaurant, for kids up to 8 years old.
- **5 Kids Playground**, next to Angkor Eye. This is possibly the nicest and biggest outdoors playground in Siem Reap. It's under a circular canopy and is in good condition. There are clean bathroom facilities for kids and a mini cafe and shop nearby. There are also basketball courts behind for older kids. \$1 for kids.

Adventure

- **6 Wake Park (<https://wakeparkcambodia.com/>)**. Excellent wakeboarding park and only one in Cambodia. \$24 for 2 hr including instructor guidance.
- **7 KKO - Off Track Mountain Bike Tours (<https://kko-cambodia.org/bicycle-tour-of-angkor-wat/>)**, St 20, Wat Bo Rd (*Close to the New Apsara Supermarket on Wat Bo Rd*), ☎ +855 93 303 656, tours.offtrack@gmail.com (<mailto:tours.offtrack@gmail.com>). KKO is a local charitable non-profit NGO. They offer unique Angkor park and countryside off track bike tours. The entire profit generated from the bike tours flows back to the local KKO School. US\$35 for a guided half day bike tour and US\$45-60 for a full day bike tour. Booking is required. US\$35-65 for a full-day tour.
- **8 Sabai Motorbike and Jeep Adventures (<http://www.sabaiadventurescambodia.com>)**, ☎ +855 88 372 3121. Explore the Cambodian countryside on a guided motorbike adventure or in a Jeep. On tour, get off the beaten path to discover authentic, rugged, and fascinating Cambodia. Sabai Moto and Jeep Adventures tours start from Siem Reap.

Cooking classes

- **9 Beyond Unique Cooking Class (<https://www.beyonduniqueescapes.com/hands-on-cooking-classes>)** (*Sivutha Blvd and Alley West*), ☎ +855 77 562 565. Daily 09:30-15:30. Cambodian cooking classes in a village 10 min from town. The classes are three hours long and include a visit to a local family and information on Cambodian cooking customs and beliefs. Hands on classes for a maximum of six people unless you book a private group. US\$32 for half-day class. (updated Oct 2017)

Festivals

- **Angkor Photography Festival: Photography for Change (<https://angkor-photo.com/about/>)**. Annual festival that showcases outdoor projections and various exhibitions around Siem Reap of regional and international photographers. The festival is held during the last week of November every year, consisting of 7 evenings of outdoor projections and more than 10 gallery exhibitions across various venues in the city. The festival is the first of its kind in Southeast Asia and is also the biggest. It aims to highlight the work of Asian photographers and provides free workshops for 30 young photographers from the region every year, led by world renowned professionals, which are showcased during the event. There is a full time office/gallery for the festival located on the East river road near the Bopha Angkor Hotel. As well as the festival, the organisers support a local NGO working with street children, that promotes the arts and runs a photography course with students. Photography from these students is also showcased as part of the festival programme.
- **The Annual Street Puppet Festival**. An exciting pageantry with the concept of sticks and stilts manipulated puppets much like those which debuted in the opening parade of the 1992

Barcelona Olympics and also quite similar to the Trinidad & Tobago Carnival.

- **The Water Festival.** This vast festival is probably the most extravagant festival in the calendar. Over three days starting with the last full moon day in October or the beginning of November up to a million people from all walks of life from all over the country flock to the banks of Tonle Sap and Mekong Rivers in Phnom Penh to watch hundreds of brightly coloured boats with over 50 paddlers battle it out. The boat racing dates back to ancient times marking the strengths of the powerful Khmer marine forces during the Khmer empire. In the evening brightly decorated floats cruise along the river prior to and complementing the fireworks displays. there is often a parallel festival at Angkor Wat and although it is smaller in scale it is just as impressive due to the backdrop of Angkor Wat. The festival marks the changing of the flow of the Tonle Sap and is also seen as thanksgiving to the Mekong River for providing the country with fertile land and abundant fish. It is at this time when the river flow reverts to its normal down stream direction. The remarkable phenomenon that is the Tonle Sap sees the river flowing upstream during the rainy season and then change direction as the rains cease and the swollen Tonle Sap Lake empties back into the Mekong River leaving behind vast quantities of fish.

Massage

The Khmer believe that Thai massage is derived from Khmer massage and that it is more relaxing as it requires less twisting and turning. The numerous Khmer-style massage shops mostly offer genuine massage and are not a front for sexual services. Contrary to common belief, blind massage services do offer "special massages" too.

- **10 Fish Massage** (*around the Pub St area*). This Thai fad has crossed the border. Dip your feet in a tank of fish and wince as they eat the dead skin off your toes. Trying a tank with feet already inside it will tell you if the fish are hungry. Some claim to have *no piranhas* while others offer a free beer to subdue any doubts. US\$1-2 for 15 min.
- **11 Frangipani Spa** (<http://www.frangipanisiemreap.com>), 615/617 Hup Guan St (*At the ANZ Royal Bank on the corner go a few metres south to the next (small) street and turn right on Hup Guan St. The spa is near the end of the street.*), ☎ +855 63 964391, info@frangipanisiemreap.com (<mailto:info@frangipanisiemreap.com>). Wonderful spa with a nice atmosphere, peaceful rooms, and experienced staff. The massages actually feel like trained people are giving them. No special services or hidden fees. It is a nice place to go as a couple or alone. They have massage tables and air conditioning. Tasteful exterior surrounded by frangipani plants (partly obscuring their tasteful green sign saying "frangipani"). US\$35-75.
- **12 Lemongrass Garden** (<http://www.lemongrassgarden.com>), 7 Sivatha Blvd, ☎ +855 12 387 385, lemongrassgardenspa@gmail.com (<mailto:lemongrassgardenspa@gmail.com>). Daily 11:00-23:00. Lovely little spa with a relaxing atmosphere and experienced staff. 60 minute Khmer massages are US\$16, while 90 minute Khmer massages are US\$23. They also offer oil massages, "spiritual massages," and manicures/pedicures. Treatment rooms have air conditioning, and they provide a cool drink before treatment and warm tea afterwards. They also claim to pay higher wages than most places in Siem Reap, as well as provide other benefits to their workers. US\$10-70. (updated Sep 2016)

Orphanage visits

Children are not tourist attractions, and especially orphaned children. Some visitors feel visiting an orphanage is a good way to make a positive contribution to Cambodia, while others feel that orphanage tours do more harm than good. The largest child protection group in the country has asked that tourists

not to visit orphanages. The great majority of Cambodian children in orphanages have living parents, who rent them to the orphanages. Most are scams and have histories with severe child abuse. It is strongly encouraged that you do not support this 'business'.

Buy

Money

International **ATMs** in Siem Reap are plentiful and most banks will do cash advances from credit cards. Two *Sacombank* ATMs can be found along *Sivutha Boulevard* west of the tourist hotspot aka Pub Street — see [Cambodia#ATMs](#). ABA Bank, which is owned by a Canadian bank, and Canadia Bank, have a big, modern branch in the center of town. They have several modern ATMs, where you can withdraw up to US\$500 with a fee of \$5, dispensing notes usually in a mix of denominations of 50s and 20s. As of 2024, the ATMs no longer have the tendency of only allowing you to withdraw \$100 bills, and will instead give you the opportunity to withdraw \$20s or in Cambodian Rial.

Shopping

Most things in Siem Reap are overpriced wherever tourists are frequent, head further away from the center or bargain (at markets).

The **Heritage Watch** (<http://www.heritagewatchinternational.org/>) non-profit organisation supports business that promote Cambodia's arts, culture, heritage and development. Certified businesses display either a gold or silver Heritage Friendly logo.



The night market

Arts and crafts

- **1 Artisans d'Angkor** (<http://www.artisansdangkor.com>), Stung Thmey St, ☎ +855 63 963 330. Daily 07:30-17:30. A workshop in the city centre. Showcases traditional Cambodian handicrafts such as wood and stone carving, lacquering, gilding and silk painting. Visitors are conducted on a free guided tour where they can see the craftsmen in action. The boutiques display the many items produced. Tours available in Khmer, English, French, German, Spanish, Japanese and Chinese.
- **2 Khmer Ceramics & Fine Arts Centre** (<http://www.khmerc ceramics.com>), Vithey Charles de Gaulle, Khum Slorkram (*on the road to the temples; 30 m after the traffic light when coming from Siem Reap*), ☎ +855 1784 3014. Daily 08:00-19:30. Glazed stoneware bowls, plates, teapots and decorative objects made with traditional Khmer ceramic techniques.
- **3 L.A. Bookshop** (<http://www.lasievphov.com/>), Wat Bo Rd. Large shop, with low prices on stationery items like books (upstairs), paper, arts and crafts, bags, kitchenware and kids' toys.
- **4 Theam's House Gallery** (<http://www.theamshouse.com/>), Veal Village, Khum Kokchak, ☎ +855 78 20 81 61. Daily 08:00-19:00. Exhibits paintings and art created by the artist-designer Theam Lim, who has studied at Ecole Boule and Ecole Supérieure des Beaux-

Arts. Theam's House Gallery and atelier are in the house of the artist, built by himself, inspired by Khmer rural architecture, surrounded by a garden.

Beverages

- **5 GIVE Kefir - Probiotic Brewery** (<https://www.givekefir.com/>). They make their own kefir and kombucha drinks. Free tasting, flavors include spirulina, ginger, beet, butterfly pea, and dragon fruit.
- **6 Sombai Cambodian Liqueur Shop & Workshop** (<http://www.sombai.com/where-to-find-sombai/for-a-free-tasting/>), 176 Sombai Road, Salakamreuk Village (*head to Salakamreuk police station, go straight over 1200 m, it is between Suorkear Boutique Hotel and Jardin d'Angkor Hotel*), ☎ +855 63 555 02 80 (Khmer and English), contact@sombai.com (<mailto:contact@sombai.com>). 08:00-20:00. This shop is the factory outlet of the locally-produced infused liqueur called Sombai. The beverage comes in nicely hand-painted bottles. The shop offers free tasting and a general presentation of the production. Also available: a range of non-alcoholic products that also come in hand-painted bottles and jars. It is recommended to book in advance. (updated Dec 2019)



Hand-painted bottles of Sombai liqueur

Markets

- **7 Angkor Trade Centre**, St 9 and Pokambor Ave, ☎ +855 63 766 666. The mall, Cambodian-style. A reasonably extensive selection of packaged food, drinks whitening deodorant, imported alcohol and the familiar feeling of shopping in air conditioned comfort.
- **8 Central Market** (*Sivutha Blvd and Achamean St*). Eclectic collection of clothes and trinkets. Bargain. Most stalls carry the same selection so you can shop around and find the cheapest price.
- **9 Old Market** (Psar Chas) (*St 9 and Hospital Rd*). Market with tourist prices, fruits and food often twice the local price and for art or cloths better assume 20% as the starting price for bargaininh. Generally a range of knick-knacks and tourist junk. Some items purport to be antique, but they probably aren't. If so, most likely it has been stolen.
- **10 Morning Market** (*near Noni Tree House*). Daily 06:00–12:00 (but better be there before 11:00). Inexpensive fruits, meat, snacks and half a dozen local eateries with noodle and curry dishes for 3–4,000 riel. (updated Jan 2024)

Eat

Eating options span the full spectrum of tastes and budgets from the rudimentary Asian staples and pizza to authentic Khmer and sophisticated fine-dining featuring exotic local ingredients. The highest

This page uses the following price ranges for a typical meal *for one*, including soft drink:

Budget Under US\$5

assortment of restaurants are in few blocks north of the old market, but there are appetizing alternatives along Wat Bo Rd and hidden in the surrounding neighbourhoods.

Mid-range	US\$5-10
Splurge	Over US\$10

Old Market area

Though **Pub Street** is better known for its bars, a handful of places serve great food, many with seating upstairs so you can escape the partying milieu on the street below. Crammed along **The Alley** is a wider selection of restaurants that offer a generally quieter and more intimate experience. The local restaurants lining **Phsar Chas** have extensive, yet near identical, menus of cheap fried rice and Westernised approximations of Khmer dishes. At dusk the Kindergarten on the corner of Street 8 and 11 becomes a jumble of small BBQ stalls, replete with billowing smoke, noise, and the persistently entreating peddlers. The *phnom pleurng* here is the cheapest you will find.



A grilled insect food cart

- **1 The Red Piano**, Pub St. 2 floors. Serves a variety of Italian and other European food with Britney Spears music videos in the background.
- **2 Viva** (Corner of 2 Thnou St & Street 9), ☎ +855 17 838 854. A bright orange Mexican restaurant. Burritos, enchiladas, and quesadillas are reasonably authentic considering the location. They have some Khmer dishes if you want to eat more local food while enjoying the view over the balcony. US\$2-6.
- **3 Williams Fish and Chips** (<https://www.facebook.com/profile.php?id=61578690916329>) (at the cobra roundabout across from the Ibis hotel), ☎ +855 76 289 3063. M-Sa 11:00-21:30, closed Sunday. Classic British-style fish and chips with mushy peas or coleslaw, and bread and butter. US\$3.50-6.50. (updated Feb 2026)

Kandal Village

Nestled in the leafy central neighborhood north of Pub Street and south of the Old French Quarter you'll find Siem Reap's rising arts and culture precinct.

- **4 Common Grounds Restaurant** (<https://www.commongroundscafe.org/>) (American Coffee Shop & Cafe), #719, St. 14 / Mundol 1, Khum Svay Dangkum (Behind Central Market, across street from U-Dara Guesthouse). M-Sa 07:00-20:00. Serving Western dishes; chicken tenders, grilled cheese, crispy chicken apple salad, German chocolate cake, seasonal muffins, cinnamon rolls and some Asian dishes. All profit goes to fund local humanitarian projects through NGO People for Care & Learning. Air-con & high speed Internet. US\$5-10.

Taphul Rd

Further west of Kandal Village you will find this pleasant street with wide flat pavements full of nice restaurants including those below and Buribo Burgers, EASTanbul, Fresh Fruit Factory, Golden Pumpkin and Madam Moch.

- **5 Bong Srey Mith Laor**, Taphul Road, ☎ +855 92 155 466, konsovatana@gmail.com (mailto:konsovatana@gmail.com). Tasty Cambodian food with lots of vegetarian options. Try the

white mint tea shake. US\$2-5. (updated Feb 2020)

- **6 My Little Cafe**, Taphul Rd, ☎ +855 12 799 284. Daily 07:00-21:00. Sometimes closes a bit early. Absolutely phenomenal Khmer food. The other dishes are great as well. Always full, with locals, tourists and expats alike. But they'll magically make a seat for you, somehow. Around \$3 mains. (updated Jan 2023)
- **7 The Source Cafe** (<https://www.facebook.com/Anytimeiscoffeetime>), Taphul Rd, ☎ +855 85 864 188. Daily 07:00-22:00. Delicious western-style cafe dishes, many healthy options and good Italian-style coffee. US\$3.50–7.50 mains. (updated Sep 2025)
- **8 Try Me Restaurant** (<http://www.trymerestaurant.com>), Taphul Rd, ☎ +855 17 419 343. Daily 09:00-22:00. A popular restaurant with a good selection of both Khmer and western food. US\$3-4 mains. (updated Jan 2023)

Wat Bo Village

Across the river from the main city center, along Wat Bo Rd that runs parallel to the riverside road and the side roads connecting them both, there are some trendy restaurants, cafes serving the most authentic Khmer food and International food. Some have relocated from the more crowded Pub Street area across the river, to this more tranquil and upmarket area.

- **9 the muffin man** (<https://www.facebook.com/the.muffinman.siemreap/>). This is a locally owned cafe, the owner is Australian trained. The staff are mostly people with mild disabilities, their menus are labelled for vegan and gluten-free options.
- **10 Peace Cafe** (<http://www.peacecafeangkor.org/>), East River Road, ☎ +855 63 965 210, peacecafeangkor@gmail.com (mailto:peacecafeangkor@gmail.com). Sit outside in a big, soft, minimalist chair in the shade of a tree while you eat delicious vegetarian versions of Cambodian and international dishes. Large menu of authentic Khmer food, grilled sandwiches, fresh salads, juices, and shakes. The atmosphere eating in the courtyard is quite nice, and a gift shop is attached. Good vegan options. US\$5-8 including a drink. (updated Feb 2020)
- **11 Viroth's Restaurant** (<http://www.viroth-restaurant.com/>), #246 Wat Bo Rd, ☎ +855 12 826 346. Stylish Khmer restaurant that is often so full you will have to wait for a table. The extensive menu is a mix of Khmer and Asian-esque dishes and with some vegetarian options. Some say the food is not spicy enough but the outdoor setting is nice if it is not raining. US\$5-8.

Wat Damnak Village

Just south of Wat Bo Village this is an up and coming area competing with its more upmarket area to its north. Lots of nice and often cheaper eateries etc to be found here.

- **12 Haven** (<http://www.havencambodia.com/en/welcome/>), Chocolate Road, Wat Damnak area (*West of Angkor High School*), ☎ +855 78 34 24 04, eat@havencambodia.com (mailto:eat@havencambodia.com). M-Sa 11:30-14:30 and 17:30-21:30, closed on Sunday. Training restaurant teaching disadvantaged young adults. Cambodian, Asian, Western Food, with many vegetarian/vegan options. (updated Sep 2017)
- **13 Molop Wat Damnak Restaurant** (https://www.facebook.com/doungrithyThy/?ref=page_internal), Rambutan lane (*south of Wat Damnak Pagoda Rambutan Ln*), ☎ +855 98 663 929. Daily 07:00-23:00. Cosy restaurant offering Organic Khmer and Western food of

high quality. The vegetables are from the uncle's farm, which can also be visited on a nice and educating half-day tour. Plenty of vegetarian and even vegan options available. They also offer cooking classes for Khmer cooking. The dishes are rich and delicious, and not too spicy. Always serve some spicy peanuts. Main dishes from about US\$3. (updated Jan 2019)

- **14 Joe's Burger Bar & Grill** (<https://www.facebook.com/joesburgerbarandgrill/>). 11:30-22:30. Burger joint. Eat in or takeaway.

Budget

- **15 Shrimp noodles and spring rolls.** A local lady doing a great noodle dish in an outside eatery. The spring rolls go for 500 riel and should definitely be tried. 4,000 riel. (updated Jan 2024)

Mid-range

- **16 Angkor Herb.** Delicious Khmer and international food. US\$6-8. (updated Feb 2020)
- **17 L'Annexe French restaurant** (<http://www.annexesiemreap.com/>), Sok San Road 17259, ☎ +855 95 839 745, booking.annexe@gmail.com (mailto:booking.annexe@gmail.com). 16:00–22:30. French food. Exquisite cuisine made by a passionate chef, who prefers excellence and quality before all. Subtle and creative cuisine in a friendly atmosphere, bringing authentic French cuisine, wines and hospitality to Siem Reap. US\$4.50-17.
- **18 Curry Walla**, Two locations Sivatha Blvd & Night Market Rd, ☎ +855 63 965 451. Authentic vegetarian & non-veg Indian food.
- **19 Neary Khmer Restaurant** (<http://www.nearykhmerrestaurant.com/>), ☎ +855 12 422 247. 16:00–22:30. Local food along with good vegetarian options. US\$4.50-17.



Amok with fish in Siem Reap

Splurge

- **20 L'Angelo** (<https://www.marriott.com/hotels/travel/repmd-le-meridien-angkor/>) (*Le Meridien Hotel*). Probably Siem Reap's most daring restaurant, serving fusionesque Italian cuisine like foie gras on a bed of white asparagus and balsamic vinegar ice cream in a setting so achingly modern that the only decoration is a cloud of black dots on the white wall. A full meal with a glass or two of wine costs around US\$100 for two.
- **21 Cafe D'Angkor (Raffles Grand Hotel D'Angkor)** (*across from the main park next to the Siem Reap River, within view of the Royal Residence*). This restaurant is inside the colonial-era Raffles Hotel. Main courses include western and Khmer dishes, and range from US\$20-30. Both the food and services were excellent. There are other restaurants in this hotel. (updated Feb 2019)
- **22 Cuisine Wat Damnak** (<https://www.cuisinewatdamnak.com/>), Wat Damnak Market St (*behind Wat Damnak Pagoda, between Psa Dey Hoy Market and Angkor High School*), ☎ +855 77 347 762, info@cuisinewatdamnak.com (mailto:info@cuisinewatdamnak.com). Tu-Su 18:30-21:30, closed M. French food with Cambodian influence. Only has two tasting menus, no à la carte dishes. Indoor and outdoor seating. US\$19-26.

- **23 The Dining Room (Park Hyatt Hotel)**, Sivutha Blvd. The quality of the food is excellent. Acclaimed by some as the best Khmer restaurant in all Cambodia, it is set in a chic hotel with a minimalist modern feel. The chefs source the freshest ingredients for both Khmer tasting menus, as well as a la carte dishes. Sit in air conditioned comfort, or outside tables and lounge furniture and enjoy the nightly music and dance performances that commence at 20:00. (updated Feb 2017)

Drink

Coffee

Coffee shop cafes with bookshelves with books for both kids and adults, and sometimes games, include Aris Café, Bayon Pastry School, Chocolate Gardens, footprint cafe, Peace Cafe, Pi Riel Coffee, Rukha Cafe (located opposite Apopo hero rats center, small a/c library attached to cafe building), Sister Srey Cafe (upstairs), Source Cafe, Temple Coffee n Bakery (Riverside).

- **1 Sister Srey Cafe (<https://www.facebook.com/sistersreycfe/>)**, 200 pokambor St, Siem Reap, Siemreab-Otdar Meanchey (*a one minute walk from the old market*). Run by two Australian sisters. Located in an old colonial building. Excellent coffee. Wonderful atmosphere. (updated Oct 2018)
- **2 footprint cafe (<https://footprintcafes.org/>)**, Street 26, Wat Bo, ☎ +855 92 800 308. 07:00–22:00. Cafe focused on sustainability and supporting local communities while serving tasty food and drinks. Vegetarian and vegan options are available. They have a large selection of donated second-hand books. (updated Nov 2025)

Alcohol

Many of the bars and pubs of Siem Reap are concentrated on a strip called **Pub Street** and its surrounding side roads and alleys. Although peaceful during the day, the streets in the Pub Street area which is just a block away from the historic Psah Chas (Old Market), comes alive with lights and music. A range of international tourists start pouring into the bars and pubs and give the streets almost a nightly street party scene.



Pub Street

Started in the late-1990s by a local business called Angkor What? Bar and followed by its rival, Temple Bar, from the across the street, Pub Street is often recommended as a must-see attraction in Siem Reap, but there is little to experience that is not already implied by its name.

The distinction between eating and drinking establishments is fairly blurry as even the most humble of restaurants can have an extensive cocktail list on their menu. Nonetheless, a vibrant drinking scene concentrated along Street 8, aptly dubbed "Pub Street", is where serious drinkers head for cheap beer, loud music and the sweaty backpacking hubbub scene akin to Bangkok's Khao San Road. The biggest and most well-known Pub St bars, Angkor What?, The Red Piano, Temple Club and Le Tigre du Papier, are easy to find, with Angkor What? and Temple Club engaged in a running battle playing pop music across the street at very loud volumes.

Travelers looking for more subdued place to appreciate a quiet drink can seek out some of the smaller places along "The Alley", "The Lane" and the adjoining streets. A few drinking holes offer a bit more than cheap drunkenness.

Most places have draught Angkor beer for US\$0.50 or US\$0.75 and cans of other beers for US\$1-2. Cocktails and spirits go for as little as US\$2. Imported red and white wine, generally from the less prestigious wine producing countries, is widely available and cheaper than you would expect. Better quality Australian and French wines are available in more upmarket establishments at a correspondingly premium price.



Pub Street at night

Beer cans tend to be cheaper than bottled beer and are better for the environment too.

KTV

These are hostess clubs popular with the locals, room charges are about US\$5-10 per hour, beer is US\$2-4. Most of these places are fronts for prostitution. Many of these places have two menus. One for Cambodians, which has cheaper prices, and one for foreigners, which have higher prices. If you see that the beer is US\$4, they probably gave you the foreigner price.

Bars

Pub Street features two main late night bars, that turn into night clubs with loud music and dancing, as the night progresses, but there are others now, the original one, Angkor What? and Temple Club, which are directly across from each other. Sadly the former has closed as of late 2025.

- **3 Khmer Pub Street Beergarden KTVs** (on Khmer Pub Street). close 02:00. There is a strip of local Cambodian bars near the Platinum KTV. If you walk past it, there is a whole 2-3 block street full of local Cambodian bars. Menus are not in English and few employees speak English, but the prices are good. These are restaurant/bars, they have young women sitting at the entrance, and you can have one accompany you for US\$1.50. Beers are US\$1. US\$0.50 for draught beer. (updated Apr 2015)
- **Angkor What?** (<https://www.facebook.com/theangkorwhatbar/>), Pub St. sundown until late. It was the most famous backpacker bar in Siem Reap, directly across from competing late night spot Temple Club. US\$1 draught beers, US\$2 mixers, US\$6-8 buckets. Large Western crowd. Offers inside and outside drinking. Open until late. As of October 2025 it looks like it has permanently closed..
- **4 Banana Leaf** (<https://bananaleaf-restaurant.com/>), Pub Street. Restaurant serving Khmer, Asian and Western food, with live music. Great cocktails. Opened in 2005 before Pub Street existed.
- **5 X Bar** (<http://www.xbarsiemreap.com/>), 102 Sok San Road (opposite Pub Street), ☎ +855 12 263 271, carlo@xbar.asia (mailto:carlo@xbar.asia). 15:00-sunrise. Open air rooftop bar featuring a 2-m skateboard halfpipe, jam sessions every Wednesday evening, live DJs and bands every week and a resident tattoo shop with a French artist. Probably the best city views in town, and unusual sunset over the halfpipe. At the end of Pub Street, look up for the X.
- **6 Miss Wong Cocktail Bar** (<https://misswong.net/#siem-reap>), Wat Bo area. This sophisticated bar serves up delightful refreshing cocktails in a sultry red lounge plucked

straight from 1930s Shanghai.

Sleep

A seemingly inexhaustible range of sleeping options from upmarket hotels, down to US\$3 dorm beds in backpacker hostels, with many guesthouses, boutique rooms, bungalows, concrete cells, wood huts and French villas in between, make finding a place to sleep one of the easiest things you will do on your trip.

This guide uses the following price ranges for a standard *double* room:

Budget	US\$5-30
Mid-range	US\$30-100
Splurge	US\$100+

Hotels are spread over the entire city but most larger hotels line national highway 6 to the west of the city centre, cheap backpacker hostels tend to surround the old market area and stylish boutique hotels are nestled in the trees along Wat Bo Rd. Small Khmer run hotels and guest houses, especially in the low season, can be surprisingly good value if you are willing to do a bit of hunting for one that hasn't been overrun by the guidebook-toting hoards.

Accommodations at every price point generally offer hot showers, cable TV, Internet and airport or bus pickup. Some may include free breakfast, though don't expect much more than an egg on toast and a coffee.

Budget

- **1 Baphuon Villa** (<http://www.baphuonvillas.com/gallery.php>), 117 St Wat Bo, Sangkat Slor Kram (near the royal residence and Rte 6; 15 min from the Old Market and Pub St), ☎ +855 63 967 177, residence.baphuonvilla@gmail.com (<mailto:residence.baphuonvilla@gmail.com>). A 16-bedroom secluded colonial-style villa with a courtyard, parking area and tropical garden. The hotel offers a range of bright, spacious and clean fan and air-con single, twin, double, and family rooms. All rooms have free Wi-Fi, cable TV with over 100 channels, private WC, washbasin, and hot showers, complimentary toiletries, and mineral water. Rooms have fully stocked minibars. A variety of breakfasts are served and the hotel offers an evening meal delivery service and packed breakfasts for those viewing the sunrise at Angkor. The hotel has its own tuk-tuk drivers and a free tuk-tuk service for guests staying 3 or more nights. Bus tickets to all destinations in Cambodia and to other destinations in SE Asia are available at the 24-hour reception. Free tea and coffee available all day. Bicycle hire. Beautifully decorated with artefacts, travel posters and photographs from throughout SE Asia. Very friendly and helpful English-speaking staff. From US\$14.
- **2 Forest King Hotel**, No. 0658, Rd 6, Chongkaosou Village, Slorkram Commune (on Hwy 6, accessible by the slip-road next to the Total Petrol Station), ☎



Sunset over the Siem Reap river



+855 63 761857. Check-in: 14:00, check-out: 12:00. A budget accommodation run by the Cheab family. Free services include pick up from bus station, tuk-tuk rides to the Old Market and Pub Street, bicycle use, daily breakfast and booking of bus tickets and countryside or Angkor tours. All rooms equipped with air-con, cable TV, mini-bar, and hot & cold shower. Management and staff are cordial, competent and reliable. Pool, garden, and a small bar/restaurant. US\$20-30. (updated Oct 2023)

- **3 Riversoul Residence** (<http://riversoul-residence.hotelsiemreap.net/en/>), St 21 Wat Bo Village Salakomrouek Commune (*From the bus station take Road 6 in Siem Reap, turn left at the first traffic light, then take the second right. The guesthouse is 50 m on the left*), ☎ +855 95 830 093. Check-in: on arrival, check-out: 12:00. Formerly Green Town Hostel, it's a bit of a backpacker-oriented, but draws a wide crowd. Clean, relaxed atmosphere with bar & restaurant downstairs. Western & Cambodian menu. 10 min walk from town centre. US\$6 gets a large room with high ceiling, open windows, fan, hot shower en suite and 70 channel TV. US\$10 gets the same with air-con. Wi-Fi throughout, free computers downstairs. US\$4 get a windowless box that at best has cold water. If you fall for paying much more than listed here (prices start high), they may give a free breakfast. Security guard. Tours, tickets and local transport available. US\$4-10. (updated Oct 2023)
- **4 Mad Monkey Hostel** (<http://www.madmonkeyhostels.com/siem-reap/>), ☎ +855 636880008, siemreap@madmonkeyhostels.com (<mailto:siemreap@madmonkeyhostels.com>). Check-in: 13:00, check-out: 11:00. Popular hostel with pool. Relocated from original town center location. US\$5.
- **5 Sam So Guesthouse** (<http://www.samsoguesthouse.com>), 164 Wat Bo Rd (*Opposite Street 21*), ☎ +855 12 602956, +855 97 6699813, info@samsoguesthouse.com (<mailto:info@samsoguesthouse.com>). All rooms are big, clean, and have a private bath with hot water, air-con, or fan, large screen sat TV and a fridge. Free Wi-Fi and Internet in the lobby. Run by Cambodian family, friendly, helpful and reliable staff. English, German, Italian and French are spoken. Various tours by arrangement. Free breakfast and free pick up. US\$9-20.
- **6 Seven Candles Guesthouse** (<http://www.sevencandlesguesthouse.com/>), 307 Wat Bo Rd, ☎ +855 63 963 380, reservations@sevencandlesguesthouse.com (<mailto:reservations@sevencandlesguesthouse.com>). Run by the Ly family, comfortable clean rooms with private hot water bathroom, air-con, fan, and TV. 2 bottles of water daily. Laundry, onward transport bookings, and free Wi-Fi. The Ly family works hard making education available to the children of rural families; volunteers with the Ponheary Ly Foundation often stay here. Four of the family are licensed Angkor Wat tour guides, speaking English, French, and Russian. Breakfast is available for a small additional fee. US\$20.
- **7 Siem Reap Boutique Villa** (<http://www.siemreapboutiquevilla.com/>), 7 Makara St (*near the corner of Wat Bo Rd and Angkor School Rd in the Wat Dam Nak area*), ☎ +855 11 876 393, info@siemreapboutiquevilla.com (<mailto:info@siemreapboutiquevilla.com>). Check-in: 00:00, check-out: 07:00. Free breakfast and free 24 hour Wi-Fi access.
- **8 Tropical Breeze Guesthouse and Restaurant** (<https://tropicalbreeze-gh.com/>), 293 Wat Damnak Village (*Cross river from Old Market & Pub St, turn right and walk for around 5 min*), ☎ +855 63 966445, reservation@tropicalbreeze-gh.com (<mailto:reservation@tropicalbreeze-gh.com>). Check-in: 14:00, check-out: 12:00. Bar and restaurant downstairs, Western and Cambodian menu. Large rooms with high ceilings, open windows, Wi-Fi, free computers downstairs, 70 channel TV, air-con or fan, en suite bath has mains pressure hot water. 24 hr check-in, security guard, security box in lobby (bring your own padlock). Free set breakfast menu of 56 items, including drinks. Tours, tickets and local transport. Visa or MasterCard accepted. Free pick up 24 hr by prior arrangement. US\$7 dorm to \$20 room.
- **9 Cheathata Angkor** (<https://cta-hotelsiemreap.com/>), Sok San Road, Sangkat Svay Dang Kum Krong (*near Pub Street and Sivutha Boulevard*), ☎ +855 63 968 777, res@ctaangkorhotel.com (<mailto:res@ctaangkorhotel.com>). Check-in: 14:00, check-out: 12:00. Colonial elegance, spacious rooms, family rooms, roof pool, spa, dining, event

space. Air conditioning, cable TV, Wi-Fi. Each room has its own en suite shower and bathtub. US\$35. (updated Feb 2020)

Mid-range

- **10 Central Boutique Angkor Hotel** (<http://www.centralboutiqueangkorhotel.com/>), ☎ +855 63 764 030. Locally owned and operated. Clean, comfortable hotel, not too far from the centre of town, with Western bathrooms, gardens and a pool. Air-con rooms from US\$29 with breakfast included.
- **11 Angkor Panoramic Boutique Hotel**, 0017, Phum Wat Bo, Sala Kamreuk, ☎ +855 63 965 118, info@angkorpanoramic.com (<mailto:info@angkorpanoramic.com>). Offers spacious rooms and amenities. Serves complimentary daily breakfast. Swimming pool, fitness facility, spa and body treatments. (updated Nov 2020)
- **12 The Cockatoo Nature Resort & Spa** (<https://www.cockatooocambodia.com/>), ☎ +855 63 969069. 7 rooms in a restored traditional Khmer house plus 2 Balinese-inspired grass-roofed cottages. Pool and lush gardens. Gourmet food served at main restaurant or poolside bar. From US\$35.
- **13 Men's Resort & Spa** (<http://www.mens-resort.com>), ☎ +855 63 963503. Male-exclusive gay hotel. The complex includes a boutique hotel with 10 stylish rooms, a large pool, a fitness centre, massage service and sauna/spa. From US\$49.
- **14 Mom's Guesthouse** (<http://www.momguesthouse.com>), 0099, Phum Wat Bo, ☎ +855 12 630 170. One of the longer-running guesthouses in Siem Reap, now in a new, if somewhat characterless, building. Mom will be happy to make all sorts of travel and transport arrangements. Air-con doubles with breakfast, hot water included. US\$25. (updated Oct 2023)
- **15 Shining Angkor Boutique Hotel** (<http://www.shiningangkorboutiquehotel.com/>), #560 Group One, Kok Chok Commune, ☎ +855 63 963096. 21 rooms. Free tuk-tuk service one way to the centre of Siem Reap daily. It is a ~US\$2 per ride back. Free, if underwhelming, breakfast. The staff are very friendly and helpful. Decor is traditional wooden furniture with Buddhist elements. Family-owned. (updated Oct 2023)
- **16 Ta Phrom Hotel** (<http://ta-prohm-hotel.business.site/>), Pokambor Ave, Mondul I, Sangkat Svay Dangkum (*river front, next to Old Market*), ☎ +855 63 380117, +855 63 760087, fax: +855 63 963528. Free in-room Wi-Fi 24 hr, restaurant, wooden interior and beautiful statues, terrace, traditional atmosphere with French colonial exterior, friendly English speaking staff, in-room refrigerator, mini-bar, slippers, air-con, hot water and bathtub, cable TV, 24-hr services and 24 hr security. Lovely hotel with exceptional wooden interior, breakfast included. US\$35-80. (updated Oct 2023)
- **Tanei Angkor Resort and Spa** (<https://www.taneiangkor.com/>), Phare Circus Ring Road, Svay Dangkum Village, ☎ +855 63 967 356, reservation@taneiangkor.com (<mailto:reservation@taneiangkor.com>).
- **17 Kouprey Hotel** (<http://www.hotelkoupreyangkor.org>), Top Town Road, Krous Village, Svay Dangkum, ☎ +855 63 765 674, info@hotelkoupreyangkor.org (<mailto:info@hotelkoupreyangkor.org>). Near Cultural Village 100 m away from National Hwy 6. Much smaller than the resort hotels on the main street, but therefore much more quiet and great ambience. US\$30. (updated Aug 2017)
- **18 Cheathata CTS Hotel** (<https://www.suite.cheathatasuitehotel.com>), Angkor Night Market Street, Steung Thmei (*between Sok San Road and Night Market*), ☎ +855 63 966



The Wat Bo temple



565, res@ctaangkorhotel.com (<mailto:res@ctaangkorhotel.com>). Check-in: 14:00, check-out: 12:00. Elegant rooms and family suites with traditional fine wood features, with free Wi-Fi, cable TV, sitting areas, mini-fridges, tea and coffee-making equipment. Suites have balconies with city views. All rooms en suite bathrooms with glass-enclosed showers and free-standing tubs. In-room dining is available 24/7. A breakfast buffet is served daily. Amenities include a restaurant, and a rooftop pool and bar. An airport shuttle and cooking classes can be arranged for a fee. US\$45. (updated Feb 2020)

Splurge

- **19 Heritage Suites Hotel** (<http://www.heritatesuiteshotel.com>) (next to Wat Po Langka), ☎ +855 63 969100. A roll-top bath, private garden, and premium linen are uncommon little extras that could help you justify the price. US\$140-275.
- **20 The One Hotel** (<https://www.uniqhotels.com/the-one-hotel-angkor>) (*The Passage*), ☎ +855 12 755 311, youaretheone@theonehotelangkor.com (<mailto:youaretheone@theonehotelangkor.com>). About as exclusive as you can get, the freestanding French colonial building has only one suite with street view balconies and a private rooftop Jacuzzi garden. US\$250.
- **21 Prince D'Angkor** (<http://www.princedangkor.com>), Sivatha Blvd, ☎ +855 63 763 888, info@princedangkor.com (<mailto:info@princedangkor.com>). Upmarket hotel and spa. 10 min stroll from the centre of town. US\$180.
- **22 La Residence d'Angkor** (<http://www.residencedangkor.com>), River Rd, ☎ +855 63 963 390, info@residencedangkor.com (<mailto:info@residencedangkor.com>). The hotel is finished in stone and wood that reflects traditional architecture, centered around a baray-inspired swimming pool. US\$395.
- **23 Sokha Angkor Resort** (<http://www.sokhahotels.com/siemreap/?pg=angkor/>) (corner of Rd 6 & Sivatha Blvd), ☎ +855 63 969 999, info.sr@sokhahotels.com (<mailto:info.sr@sokhahotels.com>). Check-in: 14:00, check-out: 12:00. A resort in the city centre with large salt-water pool and state-of-the-art lobby. The resort has 6 restaurants and bars. US\$140-2,200.
- **24 Starry Angkor Hotel** (<http://www.starryangkorhotel.com>), No G4, Rd 6, Banteay Chas Village, Sangkat Slorkram, ☎ +855 63 968 123, fax: +855 63 968 124. Offers 127 rooms ranging from superior and deluxe rooms to business, junior and Starry suites, all equipped with plasma cable TV with remote control, Wi-Fi, separated showering cabinet and bathtub. Facilities and services include Starry restaurant, swimming pool and fitness room/gym. From US\$60.
- **25 Victoria Angkor Resort & Spa** (<http://www.victoriaangkorhotel.com/>) (*Central Park*), ☎ +855 63 760 428. Very luxurious hotel, beautifully decorated. From US\$155.
- **26 Anantara Angkor Resort** (<http://angkor.anantara.com/>), National Road no. 6, Khum Svay Dangkom, ☎ +855 63 966 788, angkor@anantara.com (<mailto:angkor@anantara.com>). They offer butler services, free wi-fi, fitness center and outdoor pool. Chatra restaurant offers a walk-in wine cellar, Flame bar Starting from US\$205. (updated Feb 2017)
- **27 Raffles Grand Hotel d'Angkor** (<https://www.affles.com/siem-reap/>), 1 Vithei Charles de Gaulle. The grand old hotel of Siem Reap, this was the very first hotel to open back in 1932 and has catered to a laundry list of celebrities ranging from Charlie Chaplin to Michelle Obama over the years. Closed for decades during and after the Khmer Rouge era, it was acquired, renovated and reopened by Singapore's Raffles Group in 1997. Even if your budget can't swing a night here, dropping by the Elephant Bar for a drink (happy hours 4pm-6pm, dress code: smart casual) in the colonial surroundings is a worthwhile splurge. US\$500+. (updated Jan 2022)

Stay safe

Scams

Most locals are decent people just trying to make an honest living, but a few shady characters try every trick to take advantage of visitors' good will. Be alert to deceptive dealers but don't let suspicion ruin your trip.

Convenience stores have been known to give incorrect change and pocket the rest. Check your change before you walk out of the store and point out any short changing. Most likely they will admit to their "mistake" and give you the right change.

Street vendors and beggars in competition for generous travellers' handouts have developed cunning, if underhanded, techniques to get your attention (and money). The "beggar army" of young children will come up to you in the crowd and grab your hands, leading you to a shop where they will then try to have you buy food, baby milk or water for them. Baby milk powder seems to be a popular one. It might sound like a more humanitarian way to help than giving them money, but once you leave the store the goods you bought for them are sold back to the shop owners or to other locals and the cash goes to an adult. Young women with babies cradled in a krama perform a similar trick.

Donation-collectors for orphanages may approach you in the street claiming to be volunteer workers, showing you convincing photos of themselves in the orphanage and a clipboard listing the generous donations made by foreign visitors. Though these young adults may be well groomed and speak excellent English it's possible that your donation will go directly into their pockets. A donation (either of money, or your time) to a recognised charity might be a better way to help.

Dollar bills need to be checked, as you will find out that you won't be able to change bills with any tiny cut. Fake dollar bills are also wide spread, and can even be issued from ATMs.

NGO safari should be avoided. Do not schedule any orphanage visit unless this is the main purpose of your trip.

Underage sex

Obviously, no-one should be having any form of sexual or other inappropriate contact with children. Foreign tourists have been arrested and charged with child sex offences. To avoid suspicion, do not stay alone with young people (room, temple, school, countryside, stadium, car), and do not respond to any favour they ask of you (transport, phone call, help, use your toilet or a glass of water).



Policeman in Pub Street



Stay healthy

For general information on health in Cambodia, see the article on [Cambodia](#).

- **1 Royal Angkor International Hospital (<http://www.royalangkorphospital.com/>)**, National Rte 6, Phum Kasekam, Khum Sra Ngea, ☎ +855 63 761 888. It caters for both tourists and wealthy Cambodians. The care is not cheap, but it is of a very high standard, ideal if you have good travel / health insurance. There is a fully stocked pharmacy, general surgeon, orthopedic surgeon, paediatrician and other hospital services such as treatment for fractures and intestinal problems.
- **2 777 Siem Reap polyclinic**, National Rte 6, ☎ +855 12410778. 24 hrs. It caters for locals and tourists, adults and children. They cover many areas of care including emergency services, surgeries and vaccinations, such as rabies (\$25 per jab). The care is very good and cheap. Many staff speak English well. Open 24/7.

Connect

Internet

Wi-Fi is available in all the usual places and most Cambodians and visitors buy a local sim card with a 4G / 5G data plan from as little as \$1 per week.

Most hotels will have cable TV with many international channels such as BBC and CNN as well as those from surrounding countries. There are several FM radio stations, which include international broadcaster Radio France International on 92.0 MHz.

Post office

- **Cambodia Post Office**, 54 Pokambor Ave. Daily 07:30-12:00, 14:00-17:00. English-speaking staff. (updated Feb 2020)

Cope

The going rate for **laundry** is US\$1/kg, US\$3/kg for 3-hour service (Feb 2020).

Go next

- [Banteay Chhmar](#) - the forgotten Angkorian complex in neighboring Banteay Meanchey Province. A bit ambitious for a day trip by tuk-tuk but makes for a wonderful excursion by helicopter (about US\$2,200).
- [Battambang](#) - Cambodia's second largest city with Buddhist temples, shrines and statues.
- [Koh Ker](#) - the ancient capital, much less touristy than Angkor.
- [Kampong Thom](#) - a gateway to the world heritage listed ruins of Sambor Prei Kuk.
- [Phnom Penh](#) - the modern capital, with the Royal Palace and sites related to the gruesome Khmer Rouge regime and the Cambodian genocide.

- Thailand - the border crossing at Poipet is a couple hours away, and there are several daily buses to Bangkok
 - Tonle Sap Lake - Southeast Asia's biggest lake with floating villages and a rich biodiversity.
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